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Solicitation for Telecommunication Services

FAIR OPPORTUNITY USING THE GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION'S (GSA) ENTERPRISE INFRASTRUCTURE SOLUTIONS (EIS) CONTRACT FOR TASK ORDER 2 THROUGH 7 VOLUME I

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Table of Contents

TAB A. Volume I, Tab A: Transition Approach [L.15.1.1, C.4.1]	1
A.1 Transition Approach [L.15.1.1]	1
A.2 Task Order 2 – Transition-On Plan [L.15.1.1, C.4.2, Table F-1]	11
A.3 Task Order 3 – PSHSB WAN Transition-On Plan	12
A.4 Task Order 4 – Conferencing Services Transition-On Plan [L.15.1.1, C.4.2.1, Table F-1]	13
A.5 Task Order 5 – SONETS Transition-On Plan	16
A.6 Task Order 6 – Toll Free Services (TFS) Transition-On Plan [L.15.1.1, C.4.2, Table F-1]	17
A.7 Task Order 7 – Local Telecommunications Services (LTS) Transition-On Plan [L.15.1.1, C.4.2, Table F-1]	20
TAB B. Vol I, Tab B: Technical Approach [L.16.1, M.5.2]	1
B.1 Task Order 2 – Secondary MTIPS [L.16.1, C.3.1]	1
B.2 Task Order 3 – PSHSB WAN [C.3.2]	16
B.3 Task Order 4 – Conferencing Services [L.16.1]	17
B.4 Task Order 5 – SONETS [C.3.4]	29
B.5 Task Order 6 – Toll Free Services (TFS) [L.16.1, C.3.5]	30
B.6 Task Order 7 – Local Telecommunications Services (LTS) [L.16.1, C.3.6]	38
TAB C. Vol 1, Tab C – Past Performance [L.17, M.5.3]	1
C.1 Managed Trusted Internet Protocol Service (MTIPS)	1
C.2 Conferencing Services	12
C.3 Toll Free Services (TFS)	17
C.4 Local Telecommunications Services (LTS)	22
Appendix A—Transition-On Plan Timeline	27
Appendix B—Acronym and Definitions	33

Table of Figures

Figure A-1: Stevie Gold and Silver 2020 Award Winner	2
Figure A-2: MetTel’s Federal EIS Portal Ordering Lifecycle	3
Figure A-3: MetTel’s Site Implementation Workflow – Performance Objectives	4
Figure A-4: MetTel Standard Notification Process	4
Figure A-5: Risk Identification, Mitigation and Monitoring Actions	6
Figure A-6: MetTel Mitigation Actions to be Taken	6

Figure A-7: MetTel Service Testing Process.....	8
Figure A-8: Protocols for Service Testing Results	8
Figure A-9: MetTel’s Hierarchical Escalation	10
Figure A-10: MTIPS Testing Approach and Methodology.....	12
Figure A-11: Current Services to Support HQ.....	13
Figure A-12: MetTel Optional Pricing for Hosted EIS Compliant WCS	14
Figure A-13: MetTel TFS Services Offered in the Draft Transition-On Plan.....	17
Figure A-14: Toll-Free Services (TFS) Testing Approach and Methodology.....	18
Figure A-15: High-Level Summary of the LTS Scope	20
Figure A-16: USDA eBonding Transitions for CSVS Services	21
Figure B-1: Comparison of Legacy MTIPS and MetTel’s Current MTIPS	1
Figure B-2: MetTel’s Propose Secondary MTIPS Solutions – Benefits to FCC	2
Figure B-3: MetTel MTIPS High-Level Technical Architecture	3
Figure B-4: MetTel’s MTIPS Components Exceed EIS Requirements.....	3
Figure B-5: MetTel’s MTIPS Processing Through a DHS Einstein Enclave.....	6
Figure B-6: MPLS VRF Path Isolation.....	10
Figure B-7: MetTel MTIPS Functional Architecture	11
Figure B-8: EIS MTIPS Features	12
Figure B-9: MetTel MTIPS Performance Requirements.....	14
Figure B-10: MetTel’s V-SOC	14
Figure B-11: MetTel V-SOC Feature and Benefits.....	15
Figure B-12: MetTel’s Security Incident Handling Model	15
Figure B-13: The MetTel Team Solution for Conferencing Service Delivery.....	18
Figure B-14: MetTel Team Solution Approach for ACS Delivery	20
Figure B-15: ACS Requirements and How they are Met.....	20
Figure B-16: MetTel Team Solution Approach for WCS Service Delivery.....	24
Figure B-17: WCS Requirements and How they are Met.....	24
Figure B-18: FCC Specific TFS Solution.....	30
Figure B-19: MetTel TFS Provided Solutions and How Requirements are Met	31
Figure B-20: MetTel LTS Features and Benefits.....	38
Figure B-21: LTS Solution Architectures.....	41



Figure B-22: MetTel LTS Provided Solutions	42
Figure B-23: CSVS Performance Metrics.	44
Figure B-24: IPVS Performance Levels	45
Figure B-25: CSDS Performance Metrics.	46

TAB A. Volume I, Tab A: Transition Approach [L.15.1.1, C.4.1]

This section provides MetTel's approach for managing the transition of all task orders as a portfolio as well as address specific transition tasks associated with each task order. MetTel applies a uniform approach for managing all task orders for project managing schedule, risk, communications, and how we use common tools. The MetTel transition approach provides how MetTel will manage the portfolio of awarded task orders. Each task order has specific critical tasks, resources, or other unique elements for consideration when transitioning a specific task order. After providing our transition approach, MetTel provides how we will deploy the technical solution for each task order while minimizing the impact on FCC operations in the production environment. The attached project schedule, which is outside the page count of the technical proposal, is depicted as a high-level Gantt Chart and supplemental Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) that includes dates for performing WBS tasks. MetTel will finalize this schedule post award based on feedback from the FCC and based on awarded task orders.

A.1 Transition Approach [L.15.1.1]

When managing the portfolio of Task Orders (2, 4, 6, and/or 7) that may result from contract award to this Request for Proposal (RFP), **transparency** is a cornerstone of MetTel's entire business model. MetTel's transition implementation plan informs all stakeholders in the transition process, including the FCC PMO, GSA, Agency users, and incumbent service providers. At every stage of the transition, the MetTel Transition Team and the EIS Federal Portal provides step-by-step information to the FCC:

- Visibility into the overall transition process, including the sequence of transition orders, key milestones, scheduling, and status 24x7x365.
- Understanding of transition procedures, including providing exact instructions for the FCC stakeholders in the process.
- Access to the tools (technology, templates, reports, lists) necessary to execute transition tasks.

In addition to transparency, another key to a successful transition in the EIS contract is a mutual understanding of transition roles and responsibilities. MetTel understands that our role and responsibility as a service provider upon award is to coordinate transfer of services from the incumbent providers to the EIS contract prior to the required FCC deadline. MetTel will accomplish this transition with little-to-no downtime and no impact to FCC users. MetTel's award-winning customer support organization is organized into two divisions, New Client Services (NCS), which is dedicated to onboarding new customers and transitioning services (Day 1 support), and Customer Care, which is dedicated to delivering and managing on-going services (Day 2 support). This approach differentiates MetTel from other carriers where the services project managers are responsible for both Day 1 and Day 2 support. We do things differently with the customer in mind, as evidenced by MetTel winning both the Gold and Silver American Business Awards (from 2015 through 2020) for excellence in customer service. This is a benefit for the FCC because MetTel's assigned transition project managers will be focused only on transition and not repairs, trouble management, or billing issues.



**Figure A-1: Stevie Gold and Silver
2020 Award Winner**

A.1.1 Approach to Ordering and Implementation

After task order award, FCC authorized personnel can input individual or bulk service orders through GSA's Conexus system, directly in the MetTel EIS Portal, or by any submission method at the discretion of the FCC. Our service ordering system, built into the MetTel EIS Portal, provides a cohesive architecture to process service orders received by authorized FCC personnel, including the FCC Ordering Contracting Officer (OCO), OCO-designated CORs, or other OCO-designated ordering officials who have completed training on the MetTel EIS Portal. The MetTel EIS Portal will accept service orders from the GSA Conexus application in the Conexus data dictionary format by web service. As of the last published report by GSA, May 5th, 2020, MetTel is one of only two

EIS providers to have successfully completed testing Conexus with the MetTel EIS Federal Portal.

The MetTel EIS Portal ordering lifecycle is shown in Figure A-2. The MetTel Provisioning team will work with the Order Entry Group to validate the accuracy and completeness of each order and the Portal will issue the FCC a Service Order Acknowledgement (SOA). Each order is assigned a unique Order ID number in the portal for tracking purposes. The MetTel Provisioning Team reviews each order to ensure there are no errors or data fields that will prevent external orders from being processed and accepted by our underlying carriers. If at any point in the review process an issue arises or

clarification is required, our Program Manager (PM) will gather the necessary internal key stakeholders to resolve the issue and continue with the orders.

Post-transition, the FCC can easily place individual or bulk service orders for any Moves, Adds, Changes, and Disconnects (MACDs), track SLAs, create customized reports, and validate charges for all services provided through the EIS Federal Portal's intuitive user interfaces and innovative navigation features. While the MetTel EIS Portal enables self-service, FCC users always have the option of contacting their designated Customer Care Representative (CCR) to obtain hands-on support. We also accept manually generated orders from Government authorized users and generate MetTel service orders using the MetTel EIS Portal based on the information provided.

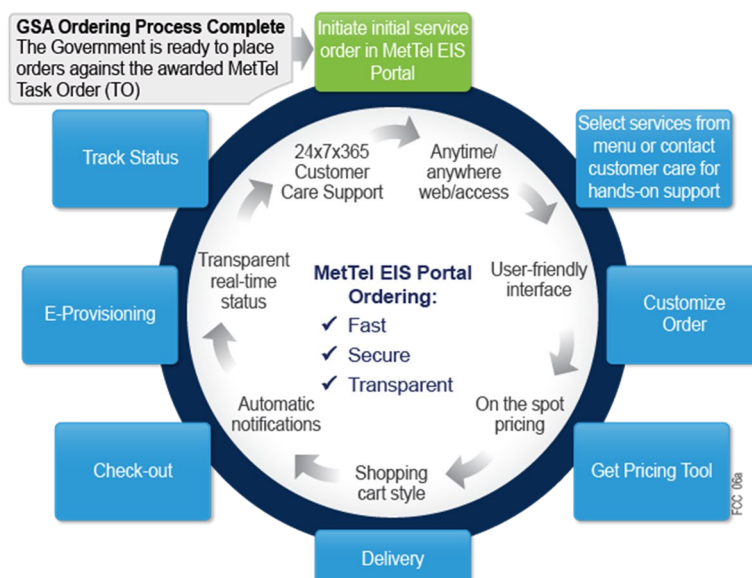


Figure A-2: MetTel's Federal EIS Portal Ordering Lifecycle

This graphic shows the steps in the Ordering Lifecycle that MetTel personnel take to ensure there is a complete closed loop approach from start to finish.

A.1.2 Major Tasks, Resources, Milestones, Deliverables

A high-level workflow of MetTel's implementation work packages follows in the "swimlane" graphic, Figure A-3. The MetTel Project Manager will report on MetTel's performance against these milestones during transition. These industry standard and EIS required milestones are used for determining schedule challenges and occur regularly enough to allow the Project Manager to mitigate delay risks to ultimately accomplish the contract standards.

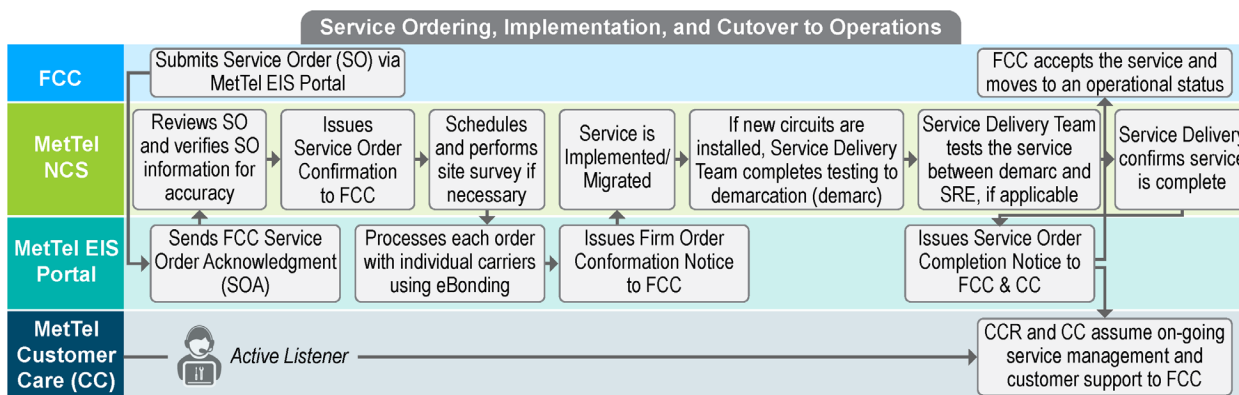


Figure A-3: MetTel's Site Implementation Workflow – Performance Objectives.

As services are deployed into a production environment, we will also plan and coordinate with FCC all change management, security management, configuration management, and FCC's service acceptance procedures.

The Final Transition Plan will include an approved schedule for completing the transition, including Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) elements with intervals, predecessors, and overall project timeline. The following table, Figure A-4 provides a greater description of the steps as depicted above.

Figure A-4: MetTel Standard Notification Process

Task/ Milestone	MetTel's Standard Process
Customer Order	- We will provide the FCC with a MetTel EIS Federal Portal account that will allow FCC authorized users the ability to order services directly into the MetTel back-office systems. - MetTel accepts manual orders using a format and submission method mutually agreed upon with the FCC.
Service Order Acknowledgement	Within one (1) business day of Service Order (SO). - If SO is invalid, MetTel submits a Service Order Rejection Notification (SORN) within five (5) days of SO. - If SO is valid, we will submit a Service Order Confirmation (SOC) notification within five (5) days of SO.
SO Accuracy Verified	MetTel works with the customer to ensure all information is accurate and complete.
Service Order Confirmation (SOC)	MetTel's portal is eBonded to carrier systems, providing order confirmations automatically that are shared FCC users portal interface. Upon receiving the carrier order acknowledgement, we confirm the SO with the FCC.
Site Survey Conducted	- MetTel will conduct a site survey for every location to validate service availability, and Site Facility Capacities (power & space). - MetTel will provide advanced notice of any site survey or installation of equipment or service at the FCC locations.

Task/ Milestone	MetTel's Standard Process
	MetTel personnel will require the proper clearance, credentials, and approval to work on premises. FCC must provide access requirements to MetTel in advance of the installation date.
MetTel Automation of ordering carrier services	MetTel has automated the ordering process with most carriers, which includes eBonding to carrier business support systems. This automation enables MetTel to directly initiate orders within carrier provider's BSS. MetTel has automated the carrier's rules and policies into our systems to facilitate all items contained within ASRs and LSRs. For these carriers, MetTel's orders flow to and from the receiving carrier automatically – no swivel-chairing between systems. Ultimately improving ordering speed and accuracy.
Access Provisioning	The carrier completes the provisioning of access based on established provisioning intervals for the ordered speed and configuration.
Firm Order Confirmation Notification (FOCN)	- When MetTel provisions local access services from an underlying Local Exchange Carrier (LEC) or Competitive Local Exchange Carrier (CLEC), we will submit a Firm Order Confirmation Notification (FOCN) indicating its Firm Order Commitment (FOC) date within one (1) business day of receiving the FOC date from the local provider. - If MetTel does not need to obtain local access services from an underlying LEC or CLEC, MetTel will submit a FOCN indicating its FOC date no later than the earlier of: 1) 5 days after SOC, or 2) 10 days before the FOC date.
Demarc Extension	MetTel Service Delivery tests the service between the demarc and the Service-Related Equipment (SRE), if applicable.
Provisioning and Testing	- MetTel works with the FCC to schedule and complete testing of the service. The FCC's location staff and Project Manager(s) are required to support testing, review test results and accept service upon a successful test. - MetTel will monitor and regulate transition of service and locations to ensure no location is left isolated.
Transition Service	All locations remain live throughout the entire transition process. At time of transition, two circuits are active at the customer location, but only one is connected. At cutover, the new circuit is connected and if there is any trouble with the new service, traffic is still active and available on the original network connection it can be swung back.
Service Order Completion Notification (SOCN)	Upon completion of the order, MetTel will submit a SOCN within three (3) days of installation and testing unless otherwise specified in the TO. If the government reports a problem within the acceptance period defined in Section E, Inspection and Acceptance (or as specified in the TO), MetTel will fix, test, and submit a new SOCN.
Acceptance and Operations	Upon acceptance from the FCC, the service is handed over to the operations team for lifecycle management. The Senior Solutions Architect is engaged during the transition phase ensuring handoff is seamless to the FCC.

A.1.3 Risk Management and Quality Assurance

The MetTel Transition Management Team actively identifies risks throughout the transition period and develops mitigation strategies to effectively manage those risks. The MetTel approach to Risk Management involves a 4-step process (provided in Figure A-5), based upon ITIL standards, with procedures for identifying, taking action to return to service, minimizing and mitigating future risks that may occur. The MetTel dedicated Task Order (TO) Project Manager (PM), Ms. Michelle Shader, is responsible for managing and maintaining the Risk Programs throughout the life of the task orders. The assigned PM is responsible for maintaining the Risk Register and providing to the FCC weekly risk reporting. The assigned PM will meet with MetTel's GSA EIS Program Manager monthly to review this register and strategize and provide solutions for

eliminating future risks to the FCC. Figure A-5 provides the steps MetTel takes for Risk Identification, Mitigation and Monitoring Actions.

Figure A-5: Risk Identification, Mitigation and Monitoring Actions

Action	Description	Risk Response
1. Risk Identification	In this first phase, MetTel will carefully analyze the Task Orders to identify and study all the possible risks that may affect performance or deliverables for the FCC. We use a brainstorming approach to create a Risk Register that lists the category of risk, a description of the risks, the impact and MetTel's mitigation for that risk. The Risk Register represents a key source of information for on-going and future projects.	We will interview incumbent contractors, customers, and other stakeholders beyond the MetTel employee team to identify and assess project risks.
2. Mitigation Planning	MetTel will perform different mitigation planning techniques to provide customized mitigation responses based on the level of impact that each of the risks has on the task orders.	We will plan preventive actions to mitigate and avoid possible impacts.
3. Mitigation Impact Analysis	We proactively analyze the appropriate risk mitigation response by considering the identified risks, their characteristics, and their level of impact on the contract.	Our approach to risk response includes four mitigation responses 1) Identification, 2) Avoidance, 3) Limitation, and 4) mitigation.
4. Risk Monitoring	We will perform careful monitoring through all the phases of the TO contract. The Risk Registers are continually updated, and we address any new relevant risks when they are identified by the FCC or MetTel.	Depending on the relevance and level of impact that each identified risk represents for this project, the MetTel PM will consider and implement mitigation and/or preventive action. Additionally, MetTel will review the Risk Mitigation Plan with the FCC on a monthly basis and at key milestones in task order implementation and provide weekly reporting.

The MetTel Quality Assurance Plan (QAP) integrates our proven task-based processes to manage outcomes and the requirements for the FCC. The QAP emphasizes correction at the point of error to ensure real or near-real-time correction of issues to minimize costs, ease processing delays, or any impacts to the FCC. Each employee is measured and incentivized to achieve all the applicable performance standards in this contract and to apply corrective action when trends or performance levels fall below the MetTel acceptable quality thresholds.

Figure A-6: MetTel Mitigation Actions to be Taken

Risk #	Description	Impact to CUSTOMER	MetTel Mitigation Actions
1.	MetTel receives inaccurate or out of date information about site location, equipment inventory, access, etc.	Wrong equipment and/or services ordered, delays in FCC schedule	Methodology: Using MetTel Quality Assurance/Quality Control methodology to analyze all information available such as FCC-provided inventory, engineering data, design documents and requirements, etc. Process: Use analyses results to prepare for detailed physical site surveys, pre-populating site-survey checklists to the maximum extent possible to facilitate data collection and verification with the local contact.

Risk #	Description	Impact to CUSTOMER	MetTel Mitigation Actions
2.	Site not prepared for installation in areas that may include access, room preparation, and existing equipment.	Schedule and service installation delays for the FCC	Approach: Build relationships with FCC and site POCs to ensure all required information is disseminated such as: site access requirements, security requirements, hours of operation, room that service is delivered, equipment is delivered, as well as other pertinent details.
3.	Service outage – new service, with no possibility of a fallback has the verification test fail and cutover is not possible.	Service implementation delays for the FCC and/or no service available	Approach: Fallback/Contingency plans developed to address service problems that prevent a successful cutover. New access is installed at all sites that have adequate facilities from the LEC. New equipment is installed at all sites. The fallback is to keep previous service on until verification of new service is live and revert to the existing services access and equipment if needed.
4.	FCC requirements change due to operational changes.	FCC products and/or services implementation delays	Tool: Employ change management process to evaluate the impact of the requested change on the implementation baseline schedule, cost, and scope.
5.	The FCC site is not ready for installation on the agreed upon date.	Products and/or services implementation delays for FCC.	Process: MetTel Provisioning Team coordinates closely with FCC site personnel on schedules for site surveys, installs, and service testing. MetTel's site survey and validation processes ensure that necessary facility build-out and site preparations are initiated early in the transition process. MetTel monitors and documents all LEC, customer, and building owner site preparation activities. Prior to the cutover date, the MetTel TM validates that site preparation work is complete.
6.	GFP/GFE does not meet the technical requirements of the specific task or service being provided at that location	Products and/or services implementation delays for a specific FCC task.	Tool and Process: Perform site survey and validation processes to ensure that necessary Government Furnished Equipment (GFE) / Government Furnished Property (GFP) are provided. Coordinate closely with FCC site personnel to ensure appropriate GFP/GFE assets are in place. All assets are managed through the Inventory Management function of MetTel's EIS Portal.
7.	Poor coordination with LECs and Field Offices prior to transition	Implementation delays for the FCC	Process: MetTel's New Client Services includes a PM that coordinates within all MetTel groups. MetTel's Provisioning group will stay well-coordinated with the MetTel FCC TM and each of the LECs.
8.	No visibility by FCC of MetTel transition on plan	The FCC has inaccurate information on transition status.	Tool: Use of the MetTel EIS Federal Portal, the System of Record, for 24x7x365 performance of the FCC network
9.	Not meeting transition milestones	Implementation delays for FCC	Tool: Built in SLAs are monitored and tracked using MetTel's EIS Federal Portal with automated notifications of potential SLA breaches. TO PM escalates to management to aid in getting the project back on track, either through more resources or tighter coordination with FCC to assure resources are applied appropriately.

A.1.4 Acceptance Testing

Services Verification Test Plans will define the test scenarios, test cases, and acceptance criteria for each implemented service, which MetTel will execute during transition to validate transition readiness. MetTel welcomes participation of the FCC representatives to observe all or part of our testing procedures.

The objective of MetTel's Service Acceptance Testing and Validation process is to ensure that services are delivered and operate properly, meet end-to-end performance requirements, and include all ordered features and functions. To accomplish this, our Service Delivery Team uses a consistent, repeatable process for testing all services.

While different testing methods and equipment are used depending on the nature and capabilities of each service, we follow the testing methodology shown in Figure A-7.

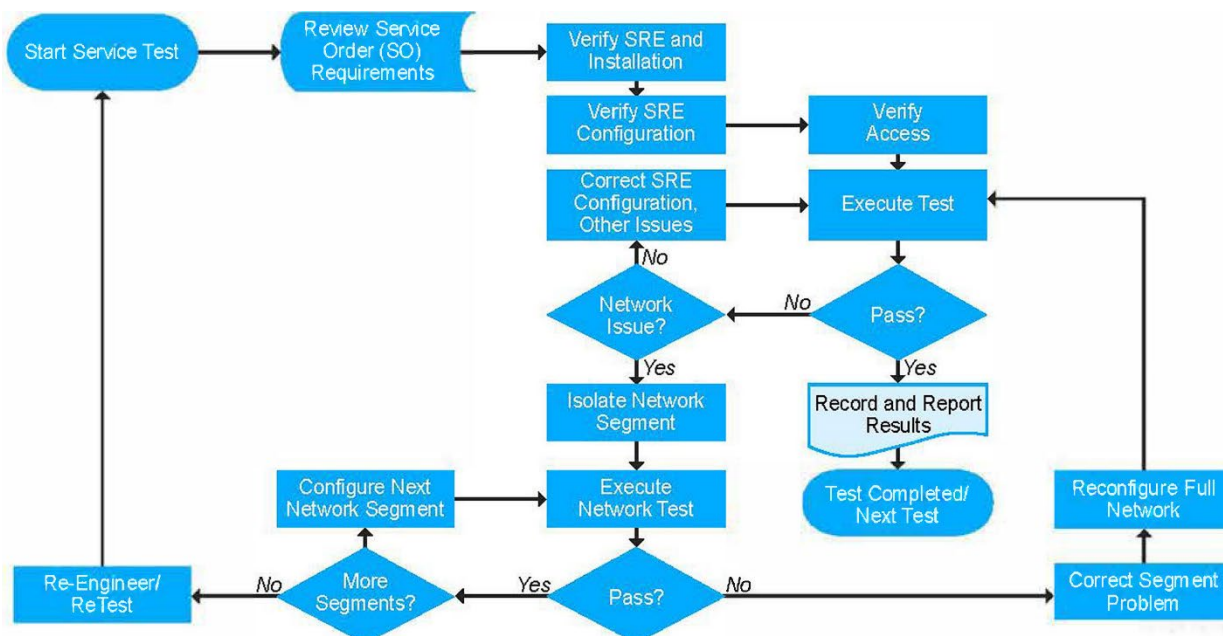


Figure A-7: MetTel Service Testing Process

This MetTel Service Testing Process shows the steps that MetTel takes from start of the testing to completion. This is a complete and thorough test, not to leave anything to chance.

The consistency of this process allows MetTel to conduct service tests and rapidly isolate problems and helps prevent delays in service implementation. We have 20+ years of experience performing service testing across our entire product suite and our government and commercial customer base.

With an FCC approved repeatable process, we will have a predictable implementation to access locations that will enable MetTel to identify and correct anomalies rapidly, thereby improving efficiency when moving from legacy services to MetTel's EIS services. MetTel will execute service test(s), including application of specified test cases to verify basic features and functionality, compliance with specified Key Performance Indicators (KPI's) for service is verified. Basic service testing outcomes are described in Figure A-8 below.

Figure A-8: Protocols for Service Testing Results

Service Test Result	Action Taken	Resolution
Service Passes all Test Criteria	Results are documented in a Verification Testing Report, showing that the tests were completed successfully, and any required certifications are in place.	Submit to the FCC for review and acceptance.

Service Test Result	Action Taken	Resolution
Service Fails one or More Acceptance Tests	Services Verification Testing team determines the source of the problem: most commonly software configuration or hardware problems.	- For software configuration problems, network segments are isolated and network tests are conducted on the first segment and continues segment by segment until the network problem is identified. - The network problem is then corrected, and the software is reconfigured. Overall service tests are repeated. - For hardware problems, corrections are made to its configuration, cabling, plug-ins or other factors. Service tests are then repeated.
Network segments are tested, and no problems identified, yet service fails acceptance test	The problem is referred to MetTel's Engineering Department. Can occur when network segments pass all required KPIs but accumulated jitter, packet loss, and/or latency cause the end-to-end network tests to fail.	- Depending on the circumstance, the service may require re-engineering, modification to the Service-Related Equipment (SRE), configuration changes, or other action to enable it to pass services verification testing. - In all such cases, resolving the underlying problem is given top priority so it can be corrected, and the service turned over to FCC quickly.

Upon completing a site implementation and test, MetTel will provide test results within 48 hours of completing the installation.

A.1.5 Monitoring, Documentation and Reporting

The MetTel escalation procedures for monitoring and reporting implementation progress are built into our processes, whether it is at transition or during the transformation of services. The MetTel dedicated TO Project Manager (TO PM) will oversee the many NCS activities that are initiated upon TO award, in collaboration with the NCS Project Managers. The TO PM coordinates among the Provisioning, Service Delivery, Client Data Analysis groups and Customer Care personnel to ensure activities are properly implemented. The TO PM will closely monitor all transition activities and escalate to the NCS Director or EIS Program Manager in the event of any anomaly or potential deviation to the transition plan and schedule.

A.1.6 Approach to Identify Critical Issues

The MetTel approach centers on regular, clear, and timely communications with the FCC and to MetTel Executive Management. With improved communications, all project stakeholders are informed, and resources are quickly approved for dispatch to mitigate risks and to ultimately drive successful performance and a great partnership with the FCC. This includes identifying critical issues and raising their attention to FCC stakeholders and MetTel executive management.

Should critical issues arise during transition, the TO PM will immediately coordinate with MetTel's GSA EIS Program

Manager. The NCS Director and EIS PM each have access to executive level supervisors who can provide the necessary corporate resources. MetTel's internal escalation hierarchy for close monitoring and reporting is depicted in Figure A-9.

Figure A-9: MetTel's Hierarchical Escalation

Escalation Level	Name and Title
1.	TO Project Manager, Michelle Shader
2.	NCS Director, Archie Powers
3.	EIS Program Manager, Patrick Amos
4.	Andoni Economou, COO/EVP

The TO Project Manager provides regular transition reporting and closely monitors, tracks and reports the status on all provisioning and service delivery activities using the MetTel EIS Portal and sends status emails to GSA. In addition, a Transition Implementation status report is provided twice per week (or at the frequency determined at the kick-off meeting), and the report includes information on any escalated issues.

A.1.7 Identification of Any Tools, Methods and Practices to Facilitate the Transition

Project management methods and tools used by the MetTel PMs include using Gantt Charts for communicating the schedule (e.g., WBS tasks, task predecessors, milestones, and critical path to completion.) As part of regular progress reviews, as any challenges to completing tasks are identified, MetTel will capture and the manage actions items needing completion to advance a task. In anticipation of task schedule risks, MetTel's PMs will maintain a risk register with mitigation strategies that is used to assist the PM with resolving "blocks" that affect performance. In some cases, this may result in engaging MetTel's Governance Model to ensure the right level of executive focus is applied to the task. Ultimately, by using these tools and methods MetTel will maintain a continuously improving process that leverages past experiences to anticipate challenges in advance and regularly communicate and report status to the Government.

The MetTel EIS Federal Portal provides automated EIS notifications as provisioning intervals are met, this benefits customers by providing timely notifications of implementation progress based on EIS contract objectives. FCC may use the portal to acknowledge or change a notification or work directly with the MetTel Project Manager.

A.2 Task Order 2 – Transition-On Plan [L.15.1.1, C.4.2, Table F-1]

MetTel will approach the transition of the secondary MTIPS in three phases: Access Provisioning, Technical Design Reference Form (TDRF) Capture, and MTIPS Provisioning. The first two phases are conducted in parallel, where large bandwidth provisioning of the AA's to connect FCC to MTIPS is the critical path. As the AA's are provisioned, MetTel will conduct a series of interviews with the FCC to complete our TDRF. The TDRF baselines the end to end configuration of MTIPS, capturing details of LAN interfaces and communities, internet routing details, and configurations for protections and MTIPS features that FCC wants deployed into the MTIPS portal.

A.2.1 Capacity for Transitioning Sites and Circuits

MetTel has capacity to transition the two route-diverse 1 Gb Ethernet Access Circuits for MTIPS. Additionally, MetTel has the capacity to go up to 10 Gb, if needed.

A.2.2 How Parallel Operations and Service Disruption is Minimized

MetTel recommends a parallel deployment strategy where new services provided by MetTel are strategically ordered in a cadence that allows parallel connectivity with the FCC's incumbent carrier. MetTel follows procedures where the services are monitored during an initial testing period to validate continuity and error-free operation. Upon validation of all testing and continuity of performance, MetTel will activate dynamic routing protocols to give the MetTel provided path precedence during the transition while allowing for any rollback functionality to the incumbent carrier provided service, in the event of performance degradation. Once the new primary path is verified, all testing is conducted and successfully passed, the incumbent carrier's platforms can be disconnected.

A.2.3 Major Tasks, Resources, Milestones, and Deliverables

As previously stated, the three major tasks for implementing MTIPS are AA Provisioning, Technical Design Requirements Form (TDRF) data capture and completion, and MTIPS Portal Configuration and test. The completed TDRF is a major deliverable that requires close coordination with the FCC before completing the MTIPS portal configuration. The EIS provisioning for EIS products include Firm Order